



You get out sideways.

Fighting a rip current exhausts you. If you cannot swim free, float and signal for help.

Why extending 'in China for China' into 'from China to the world' might be smart for Europe.



Volkswagen ID. ERA 9X

The placard said 299,800 yuan.

About €38,300. A promotional price. 5,207 mm, a 1.5-liter range extender, six seats.



Inside the ID. ERA 9X

Quilted captain's chairs in row two.

Visible materials, packaging and fit: judge for yourself.



Who built it

A Volkswagen joint venture.

SAIC Volkswagen badging on the tailgate. A 50:50 Volkswagen–SAIC joint venture, represented on Volkswagen’s balance sheet as an equity-accounted investment—not a license or an acquisition.



ONVO L90

265,800 yuan. About €34,000.

NIO's sub-brand. Three rows. The display card showed the same starting price announced at the original launch.



Li L9

Presented as an embodied-intelligence flagship.

Displayed in a shopping mall rather than a traditional dealership. A visual benchmark, but not a direct price peer: the 2026 Li L9 started at 459,800 yuan.



Xiaomi SkyNomad N70

259,900 yuan pre-sale. About €33,200.

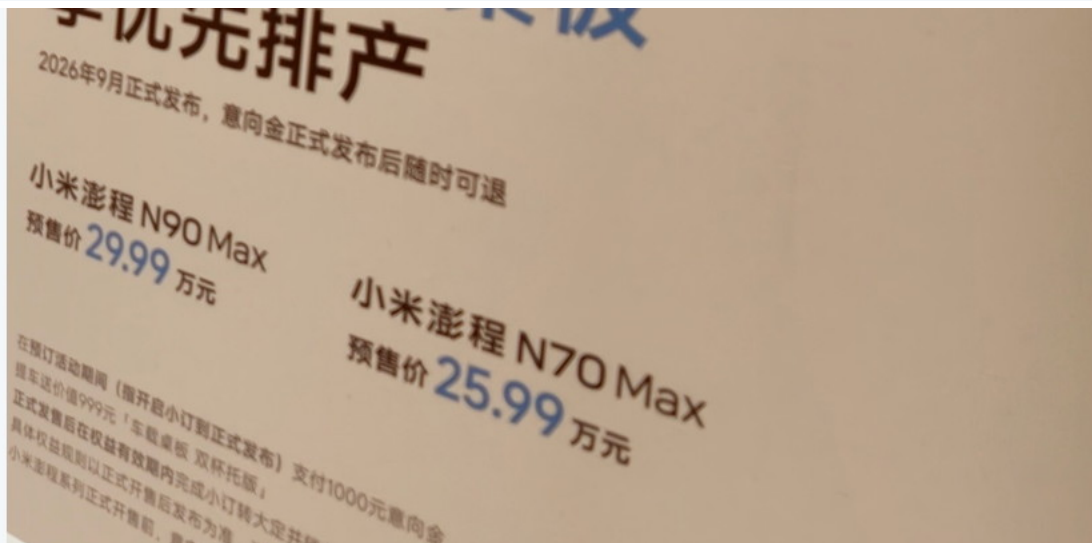
The store card indicated a September 2026 launch. Xiaomi's first range-extender SUV, displayed in a Xiaomi store.



Under the hood

Chinese engine. Global supply chain.

The 1.5-liter range extender comes from Harbin Dongan, a Changan subsidiary. The photographed Bosch component was made in China. European competence did not disappear; it became embedded in a Chinese ecosystem.



Two placards, nine days apart

299,800 and **299,900**

A promotional price on the Volkswagen; a pre-sale price on Xiaomi's larger N90 Max. One hundred yuan apart. Not comparable trims—but a revealing illustration of local price pressure.

What actually stands in the way of bringing it to Europe

Shipping is the easy part.

- EU type approval
- UN R155 cybersecurity management
- UN R156 software-update management
- Personal vehicle data under GDPR
- EU countervailing duties: qualifying BEVs, including vehicles propelled solely by electric motors with an internal-combustion range extender; conventional PHEVs currently remain outside the measure

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In a rip current, fighting the flow exhausts you. If you can, swim parallel. If you cannot, float and signal for help. You get out sideways.

Germany has to restore its competitiveness.

Using what German companies already build in China is not the whole answer.

It is a sideways move that buys time to find one. The next step is finding the right partners to turn that time into speed.

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